

● Design revision · September 2026

Calm Confidence

A ground-up interface redesign for ScamShield — moving the app from a neon security console to something a frightened person can read in five seconds and act on.

SCOPE

Design system,
component kit,
5 core screens

PRINCIPLE

Colour means
something.
Stillness is a feature.

RESULT

One accent,
zero ambient motion,
no shouting

The app was dressed as a hacking tool

ScamShield's users are, disproportionately, the people scams actually work on — someone who just got a text about their bank and whose pulse is up. The old interface met them with a pulsing radar sweep, six shouted navigation labels and a risk score out of 100.

What the old Home spent its space on

A 140px pulsing shield inside an ambient radar sweep · a "SHIELD ACTIVE / ECOSYSTEM" badge that read the same after 0 scans and after 400 · a 2×2 grid of stat cards including "AVG RISK SCORE" · and a banner listing "Androguard + YARA", "Zero dummy data".

Roughly the entire first screen passed before anything the user could act on appeared.

What people actually open it for

One question, every time:

"Is this thing I just received safe?"

Everything on the screen now either answers that question, or gets out of the way of the thing that does.

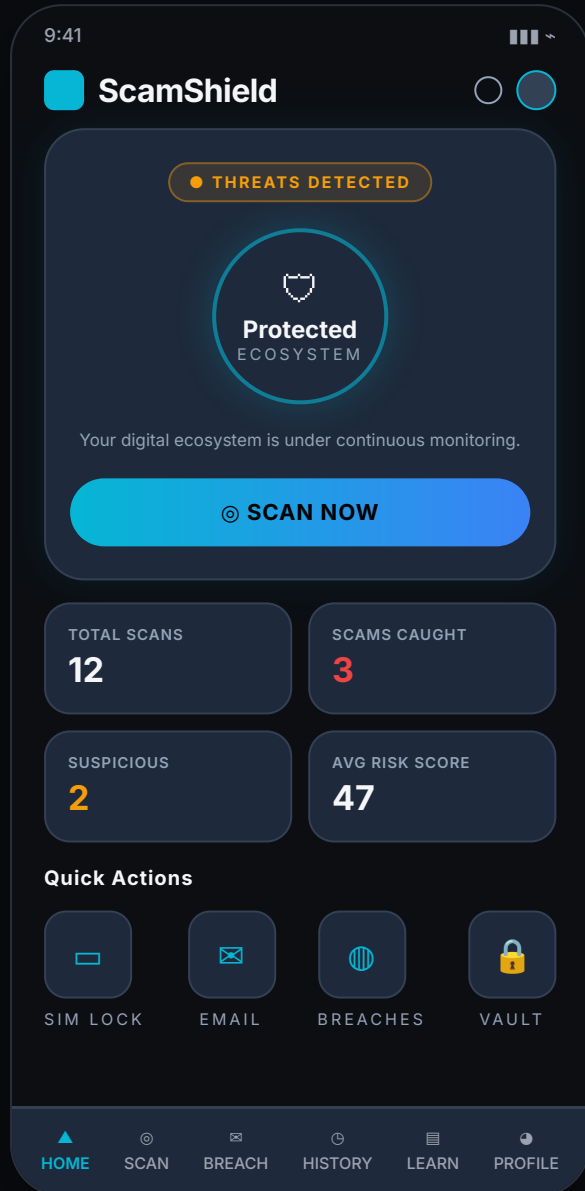
FOUR RULES THE SYSTEM IS BUILT ON

- 1 Colour means something**
Green, amber and red belong to verdicts and nothing else. When every card carries a cyan glow, a red "Scam" banner is just more colour. Neutrals do the structural work; one accent marks what is interactive.
- 2 Sentence case, real hierarchy**
ALL-CAPS with +1.5 tracking is measurably harder to read and shouts at someone already anxious. Nineteen shouted labels were removed. Size, weight and colour carry hierarchy instead.
- 3 Stillness is a feature**
Motion happens on state change, never on a loop. The pulsing CTA and the radar sweep are gone. A screen that never settles keeps taking attention without giving anything back.
- 4 Space over ornament**
Glows, gradients and drop shadows removed until something broke. Depth now comes from one surface step and a hairline border.

Before & after

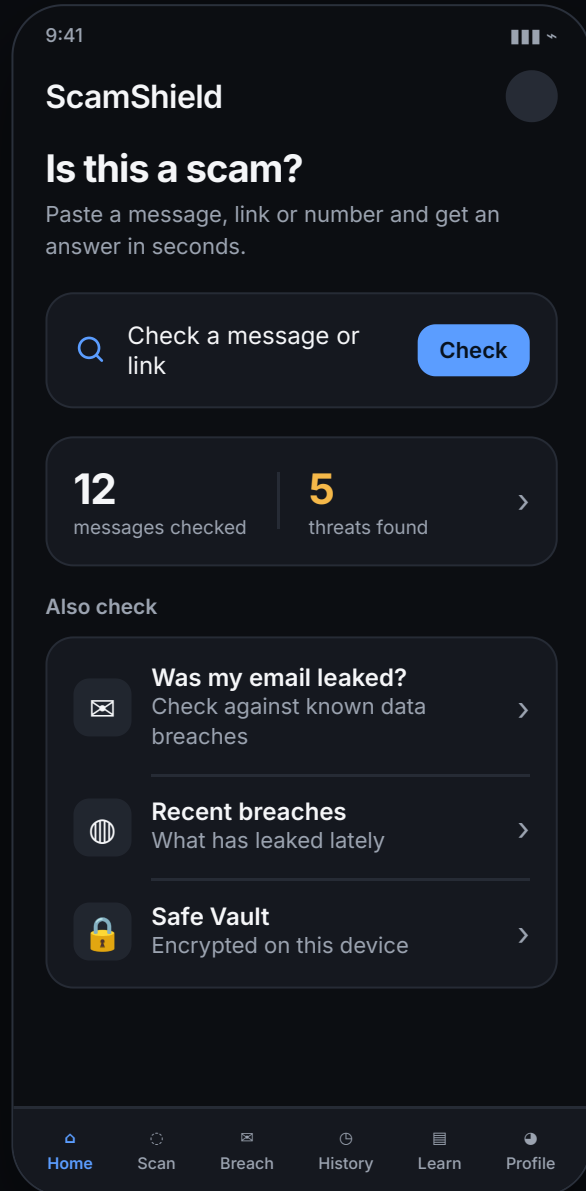
The same screen, the same data, the same feature set — reordered around the decision the user is actually trying to make.

BEFORE



Time to first useful control: after a full scroll past a radar animation, a status badge and four numbers.

AFTER



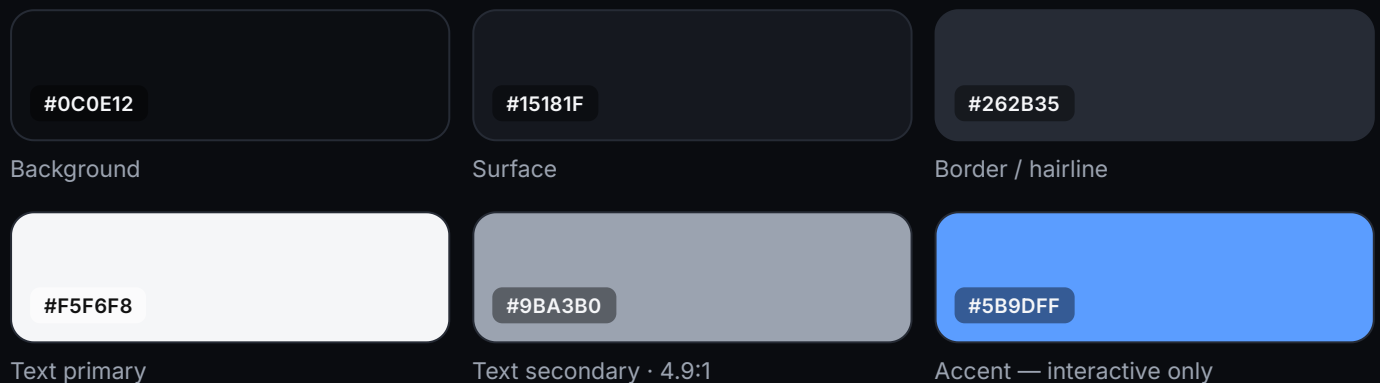
Time to first useful control: immediately — it is the first element, and the whole card is the tap target.

Design tokens

Defined once in `lib/theme.dart` and referenced everywhere. Retuning them restyles the whole app — including the fourteen screens that were not individually rewritten.

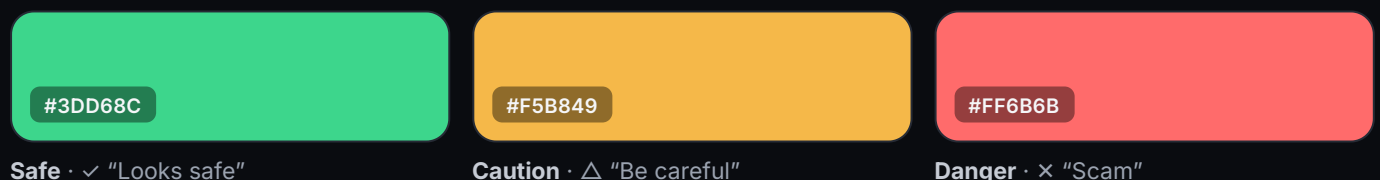
Neutrals carry the structure

The background moved off navy to a true neutral charcoal. Navy tints everything drawn on it blue, which is what forced the old accent to shout to be seen at all.



Three colours are reserved

These never appear as decoration, section headers or flavour icons. Every place they are used is also labelled in words and paired with a distinct icon — roughly one in twelve men cannot separate red from green, which is precisely the distinction this app exists to communicate.



Type — Inter, optically tracked

Display · 32/700

Title · 24/700

Heading · 19/600

Subheading · 16/600

Body · 15/400 · 1.5 leading

Secondary · 13.5/400

Label · 13/600 — sentence case

Larger text is tracked tighter, small text marginally looser, approximating an optical-size axis Flutter does not expose.

The old theme layered *extra positive* tracking on top for "tactical" labels — that is the letter-spacing this redesign removes.

Space & radius

Everything is a multiple of 4 — which is what stops a layout looking hand-placed. Three radii plus a pill; more than that and nothing looks related.



Motion: 140ms / 220ms, easeOutCubic, on state change only. No ambient loops anywhere in the app.

Component kit

Before this existed, every screen hand-rolled its own Container with its own padding, radius and border alpha — which is why “a card” looked subtly different on Home, History, Family and Profile. Six components cover essentially every layout in the app; a kit that tries to cover every case stops being learnable.

AppCard

One radius, one border, one padding. Optional verdict tone.

Toned — verdict only

The tone variant exists for the scan result. It is not used for decoration.

VerdictBadge

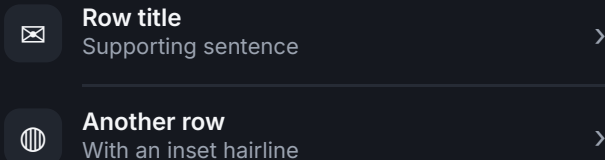
✓ Looks safe

⚠ Be careful

✗ Scam

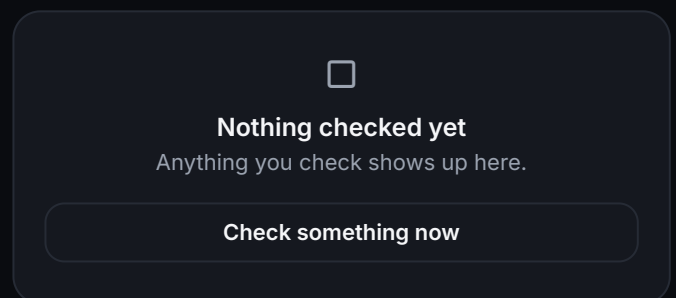
Always icon *and* word — never colour alone. One source of truth (`verdictStyleFor`) means Scan, History, Home and Simple Mode cannot describe the same result three different ways, which they previously did.

AppListRow · AppListGroup



Neutral icon tiles. Fifteen accent-coloured icons down a settings list is fifteen things asking to be looked at.

EmptyState

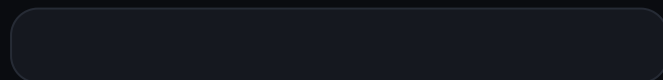


Treated as a real state with an action — for a new install it is the first thing most screens show.

AppSection

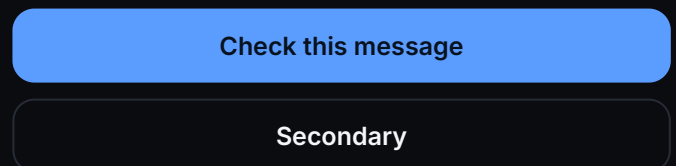
Recent checks

[See all](#)



Sentence case, muted — replacing “RECENT CHECKS”.

Buttons



52pt tall — past the 48dp floor, because a mis-tap here costs more than in most apps. Flat: the gradient is gone.

The scan, and the answer

The verdict is the single most important thing this app ever renders. It now leads with what to *do*, not what was measured.

INPUT

9:41

Check a message

Text

Link

Voice

Image

Paste the suspicious message here

Paste

Scan QR

Check this message

Try an example

"URGENT: your account is locked. Verify at bit.ly/..."

VERDICT

9:41

Check a message

Clear

×

Scam

Do not reply, tap any link, or send money. It is safe to delete this.

What we found

Impersonates a bank and pushes you to act within minutes using a shortened link.

Why

- Urgency & pressure
"within 24 hours", "account locked"
- Shortened link
Hides the real destination

Risk score 91/100 · AI-assisted

Was this right?

Correct

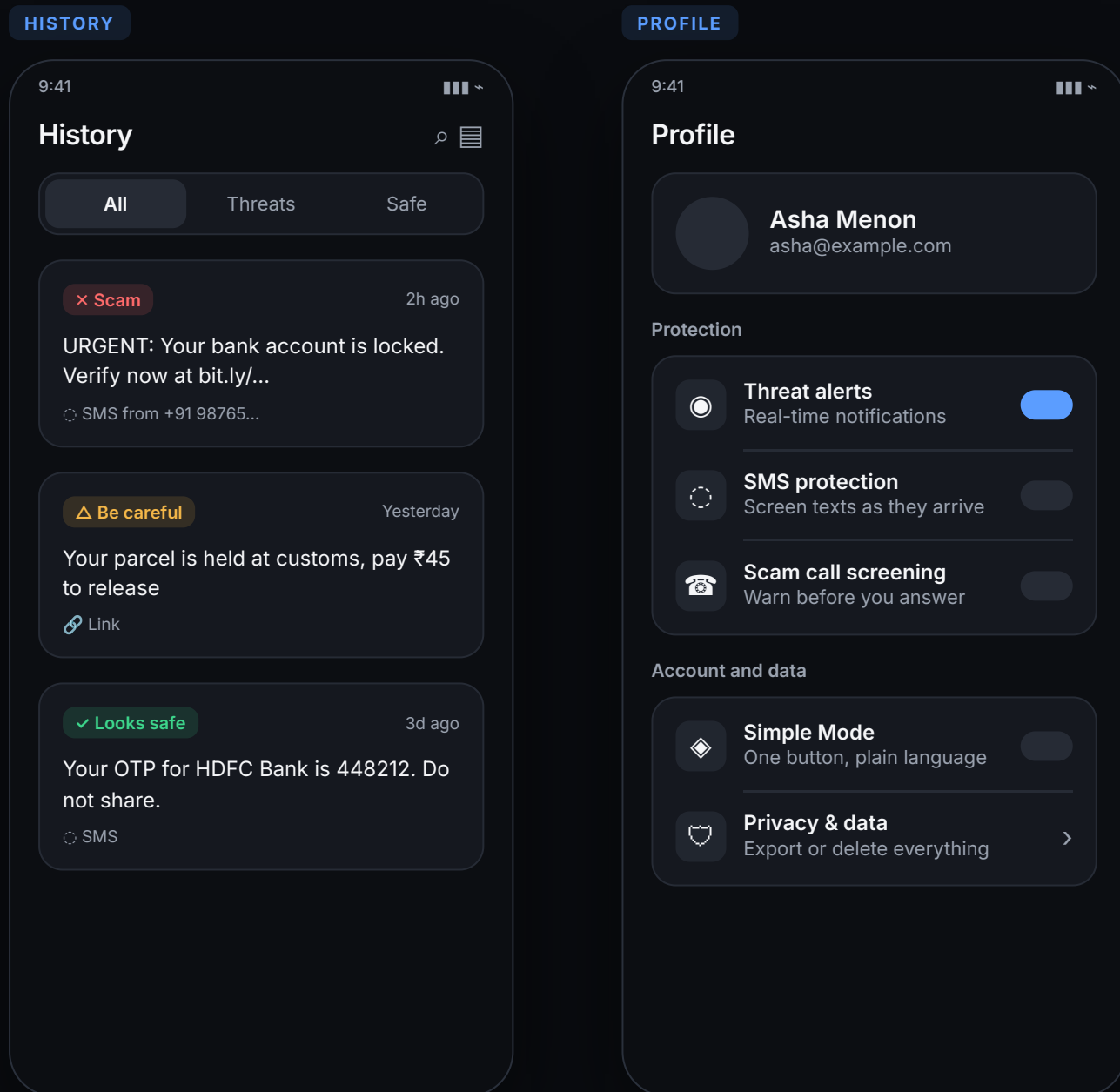
It's legitimate

What moved, and why it matters

The old result card opened with a coloured word, a "GEMINI AI" badge and "Risk Score: 87/100" — a measurement, a vendor name and a number nobody can act on, all above the advice. Someone reading this is often mid-decision about whether to tap a link or send money. The instruction now comes first; the score is a footnote. The provider label was also simply wrong much of the time — analysis falls back to Groq or to the on-device engine, and the footnote says so honestly.

History & Profile

Both were dense grids of tinted icons and shouted labels. Both are now scannable lists built from the same kit.



The message leads. It used to sit third, under a repeated ALL-CAPS verdict word and a coloured icon tile — but the message is what people scan the list looking for.

“Intelligence Settings” became “Protection”. Every icon tile is neutral, so the switches — the things you came to change — are what the eye lands on.

SUMMARY

What changed

AREA	BEFORE	AFTER
Palette	Navy + neon cyan on everything; glows under every card	Neutral charcoal, one calm accent, three reserved verdict colours
Type	ALL-CAPS + 1.0–1.5px tracking on 19 labels	Sentence case throughout; hierarchy from size, weight and colour
Home	Radar sweep, pulsing CTA, 4 vanity stats, engineering brag banner	Scan entry first, one honest status line, labelled tool rows
Verdict	Coloured word → vendor badge → risk score → advice last	Verdict → what to do → detail → score as a footnote
History	"All Logs (12)", icon tile + repeated verdict word, message third	Message leads, compact verdict chip, source line
Motion	Permanent pulse + 4s radar loop	State-change only, 140/220ms
Consistency	Every screen hand-rolled its own card	Six shared components in ui_kit.dart

Reach

The token names in AppColors were kept deliberately unchanged. Around five hundred references across twenty-odd screens point at them, so re-tuning the values restyles **the entire app** — including the fourteen screens not individually rewritten — without a single call site needing to change. Five screens got the full structural redesign on top: Home, Scan, History, Profile and the navigation bar.

What this document is, honestly

These are design renders built from the same tokens as lib/theme.dart — not screenshots of a running build. There is no Flutter SDK in the environment this was produced in, so the Dart could not be compiled or launched here. Every widget API used was checked against the real signatures in the codebase, and every file was verified to have the same structural balance as its committed baseline, but **running flutter analyze and launching the app on a device is still the step that confirms it.**

The obvious next move

A light theme. The system is already token-driven, so it is mostly a second ThemeData — but the fourteen un-rewritten screens hardcode light-on-dark colours, and flipping the default before those are migrated would leave unreadable text in places nobody would find until a user did. It is a follow-up with a real migration behind it, not a switch to flip.